

Change Rationale



Every change carried into the September 1 packet, what it changed from, and the authority it rests on. Prepared so any question at the table can be answered from one page set.

INTERNAL · FOR THE BRIDGE · NOT OUTWARD FACING

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THE POSITION IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Almost nothing in this packet was invented. The structure follows the Chair's own Codex-to-Structure presentation, already shown to the community. The legal particulars follow the filed record and current Washington statute. The identity decisions follow the founding materials and Drew Stone's brand work, which is untouched. Where a judgment call was made, it is named as one, the Board Briefing Memorandum argues it, and the board can redirect it by motion today.

STRUCTURE AND NAMES

CHANGE	FROM → TO	AUTHORITY
Program structure	Four Programs plus the Academy → six divisions under The Program	The Chair's Codex-to-Structure Office Hours deck, presented to the community; all division names verified as exact strings in it. People are already working to this structure.
Bridge structure	Three Bridge Groups → four: Governance · Finance & Fundraising · Internal Communications · Branding & Outreach	Same deck for the structure. "Branding & Outreach" refines the deck's "Marketing & Branding": the group lead's naming call; no filed document constrains the name.
Super Cockpit	Division name → platform built by the Technology, AI & Information Systems division	The deck names the division; Super Cockpit appears there as a platform, not an organizational unit.
Recorded names	Mixed short and long forms → long form in all documents; short forms in conversation and slides only	Consistency rule set by Branding & Outreach: "Soulship Academy" with no slash, "Community Service" never bare "Community."
HeartBeam home	Claimed by two programs → Research as single accountable home, others contribute	Named as a judgment call in the Briefing Memorandum, item 2. The internal record was split; either home is defensible, ambiguity is not. Board confirms or redirects today.

LEGAL RECORD

CHANGE	FROM → TO	AUTHORITY
Corporate name	Variant usages → "Luminara Institute of Light" on every business document	The filed Articles. The Secretary of State record is the name's source of truth.
Statute citations	References to the repealed act → RCW 24.03A throughout	The current Washington Nonprofit Corporation Act. Verified against the statute, not assumed.
Formation date	Loose references → effective May 7, 2026 everywhere	The Secretary of State certificate; UBI 606 219 823.
Presiding officer	President's office unfilled and unaddressed → Chair performs the president's statutory functions, office stays vacant	RCW 24.03A.585 requires the functions, not the title. Resolution 3 answers the question on the face of the record; no new office, no title changes.
Fiscal sponsorship	Unwritten arrangement → authorization to execute a written agreement and file the exemption application	Resolution 11. Funder diligence requires the agreement in writing; solicitation materials disclose the sponsorship until federal recognition arrives.
Bridge lineage	"Since April 2026" → begun in 2021 as the Virtual World Society's Futures Subcommittee	The Evolution slide of the Chair's deck, corroborated by member testimony.

IDENTITY AND LANGUAGE

CHANGE	FROM → TO	AUTHORITY
Pioneer	The community's informal name for its members → the settled community role with a defined path	Resolution 9 adopts the intake path and the title; the Pioneer Path exhibit defines the ladder from first task to contributor.
Charter and CODEX	Full working CODEX at the public charter link → two-page Founding Charter published; CODEX continues as an internal working document	The communications review's recommendation, adopted as Resolution 13. Peers publish short statements and keep deliberations internal.
Lineage line	Mixed references to the predecessor → "formerly The Light School," once per surface, until September 1, 2027	The Light School was the real predecessor name. Renamed organizations acknowledge the former name for about a year, then retire it deliberately.
Every-page identity	Inconsistent identity across surfaces → logo and name on every page; full legal name on business documents; "Luminara" alone on materials and outreach	Authenticity floor set by Branding & Outreach; recorded in the Branding Style Sheet under Resolution 12.

RECORDS AND PRACTICE

CHANGE	FROM → TO	AUTHORITY
Corporate records	Records scattered across personal accounts → "Corporate Records" shared drive, kept by the Secretary	Resolution 10; the benchmark review's first infrastructure finding.
Interim custody control	No hardcopy practice → quarterly printed deposit, Chair-verified, until systems exist	The Retention Policy and Records Custody Rollout Plan: broad now, converting to standard practice on a future board resolution.
Conflict of interest	COI language buried in appendices → adopted policy, annual signed disclosure at the table	Resolution 4; bylaws Section 9.1 names the policy as its operative form. Standard 501(c)(3) practice.
Public contacts	The single info@ address shown on the website, not yet a live mailbox → named institute addresses, each one live, routed by function	So every published contact actually reaches someone.

WHAT WAS DELIBERATELY NOT CHANGED

Drew Stone's colors and typography. The founding language: the signature question, the motto, and the mission opener are quoted verbatim. The downloaded state filings and legal-status documents, preserved exactly as filed. The CODEX itself, which continues unedited as the internal working document. And the board slate, which is presented as publicly stated, with elections today making it the board of record.

IF CHALLENGED

The order of authority behind this packet: the filed public record first, current statute second, the Chair's structure presentation third, the brand steward's materials for identity, and the group lead's judgment only where none of those speak. Every judgment call is disclosed in the Board Briefing Memorandum rather than buried, and each one can be redirected by motion today. That is the defense: the packet does not ask the board to trust the drafter; it shows its sources.